

RAÍCES

Additional Resources

Prayer: A Guide for New Believers

Prayer is one of the spiritual disciplines you already learned about in your RAÍCES journey. This guide goes a little deeper, using the model of prayer Jesus Himself taught us. It isn't a formula to memorize and repeat — it's a map to help you talk with God more confidently.

What is prayer?

Prayer is a sincere conversation with God. It's how we express worship, confession, gratitude, and bring our requests to our Heavenly Father. It's not a religious monologue or a list of requests — it's a relationship.

- It's a direct connection with God.
- It's an expression of your faith and your dependence on Him.
- It strengthens your personal relationship with the Lord, the more consistent you are.

Because of Jesus' sacrifice, you have direct access to the Father in prayer — you don't need a mediator or a perfect formula to come to Him.

Hebrews 4:16: *"Let us therefore come boldly unto the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy, and find grace to help in time of need."*

1 Thessalonians 5:17: *"Pray without ceasing."*

Philippians 4:6: *"Let your requests be made known unto God, in every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving."*

Jesus' model for prayer

In Matthew 6:9-13, Jesus taught His disciples a simple structure for prayer, known as the Lord's Prayer. It isn't the only way to pray, but it's an excellent starting point, especially when you don't know where to begin.

Matthew 6:9-13: *"After this manner therefore pray ye: Our Father which art in heaven..."*

If you feel like you don't know what to say when you pray, don't worry — that's normal at first. You can use these six parts as a guide, in your own words, until praying starts to feel more natural to you.

1. Worship — v. 9

"Our Father which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name." You recognize God as your loving, sovereign Father, and honor His name above everything else in your life.

2. Surrender to His will — v. 10

"Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven." You pray for God to work in your life and in the lives of others, submitting to what He knows is best, even when you don't fully understand it.

3. Asking for your needs — v. 11

"Give us this day our daily bread." You bring your daily needs, physical and spiritual, trusting that God will provide, one day at a time.

4. Confession and forgiveness — v. 12

"And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors." You acknowledge your shortcomings and ask for forgiveness, knowing God is faithful to forgive you. At the same time, you commit to forgiving others, just as you've been forgiven.

1 John 1:9: *"If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness."*

5. Protection — v. 13a

"And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil." You ask for strength to resist temptation, and trust that God protects you even when you can't see the danger.

Ephesians 6:10-11: *"Be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might. Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil."*

6. Doxology — v. 13b

"For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen." You close your prayer by acknowledging God's greatness — a way of ending with confidence and praise, not doubt.

Practical exercise

Set aside 10 minutes a day to pray following this structure. It doesn't need to be long or perfect, just consistent:

- Begin by worshiping God (Worship).
- Surrender to His will for your life (Surrender).
- Ask for your daily needs (Petition).
- Confess your sins and forgive others (Confession).
- Ask for protection and guidance for your life (Protection).
- Close by exalting God (Doxology).

If you'd like, memorize the whole Lord's Prayer and recite it during your devotional time, pausing at each part to reflect before moving to the next.

In closing

Prayer is a gift from God that lets you approach Him with confidence, without complicated formulas or special language. Following the model Jesus Himself left us, you can pray with purpose starting today. Start where you are, and trust that God hears and answers His children.